

Tuesday, 16 June 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Light drizzle

26° 16°

BIRMINGHAM

Light rain

23° 16°

MANCHESTER

Rain

23° 14°

GLASGOW

Rain

17° 10°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

Russia was behind arson attacks targeting PM, BBC reveals.

Evidence shows Russians directing the plot and stoking tensions with fake far-right and Muslim groups.

UK · NEWS

2

Teacher guilty of sexually abusing and murdering adopted baby.

Preston Davey died after months of sexual and physical abuse at the hands of Jamie Varley.

UK · NEWS

3

Under-16s to be banned from TikTok, YouTube and other social media by next spring, Starmer says.

Sites including Instagram, YouTube and TikTok will become inaccessible for millions of children, the prime minister has announced.

POLITICS · UK

4

Nowak killer's 'unduly lenient' sentence to be reviewed.

The sentence of Vickrum Digwa, who was convicted of the murder of Henry Nowak, has been referred to the Court of Appeal.

UK · NEWS

5

Canadian lynx one of big cat sightings in Welsh countryside.

Fifteen "big cats" were reported to authorities in Wales between January 2020 and July 2025.

UK · NEWS

What's coming up

- 1 Bonnie Tyler out of coma but 'very unwell' after emergency surgery.**
The Total Eclipse of the Heart singer was put in an induced coma after emergency intestinal surgery.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 2 US musician Oliver Tree dies in helicopter collision in Brazil.**
The singer-songwriter is among six people presumed dead in an air crash over Rio de Janeiro on Sunday.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 3 Award-winning investigative journalist Roger Cook dies aged 83.**
The New Zealand-born reporter was credited with having invented the doorstep interview technique.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 4 Linkin Park ignore the noise with triumphant set at Download Festival.**
Limp Bizkit and Guns N' Roses were the other headliners at this year's metal and rock extravaganza - we went along.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 5 'Idris Elba punched me and it was great fun'.**
Delilah O'Riordan, 14, says it was "great fun" filming stunts with the Hollywood star.
SHOWBIZ · UK

On the schedule

- 1** **Fifa seeks explanation over VAR official's hand gesture.**
Fifa is seeking an explanation over a hand gesture made by video assistant referee Shaun Evans before Germany's 7-1 win over Curacao on Sunday.
SPORT · UK
- 2** **Palace appoint Sage as head coach on three-year deal.**
Crystal Palace appoint Lens manager Pierre Sage as their head coach on a three-year contract to succeed Oliver Glasner.
SPORT · UK
- 3** **McCullum worried for Stokes as coach gives no captaincy backing.**
Brendon McCullum refuses to be drawn on Ben Stokes' future as England captain, but repeatedly speaks of his "worry and concern" for the all-rounder.
SPORT · UK
- 4** **False nines? 4-4-2? The tactical trends defining World Cup so far.**
The return of 4-4-2? False nines? BBC Sport looks at the tactical trends emerging at the World Cup so far.
SPORT · UK
- 5** **GB's Jones misses match points in Nottingham loss.**
Britain's Francesca Jones misses two match points in a narrow defeat by Talia Gibson in the Nottingham Open first round.
SPORT · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new trend sees garden enthusiasts creating miniature 'wildlife hotels' in their backyards to support local biodiversity.**
These charming little structures provide shelter for insects, hedgehogs, and other small creatures, turning gardens into havens for nature.
- 2 The enduring appeal of 'board game nights' is making a strong comeback, with families and friends rediscovering classic and new tabletop games.**
It's a wonderful way to connect, laugh, and enjoy some screen-free quality time together, away from digital distractions.
- 3 Research suggests that wearing bright colours can genuinely boost your mood and even make you feel more energetic.**
So, if you're feeling a bit grey, perhaps a splash of sunshine yellow or a vibrant blue in your wardrobe could make all the difference.
- 4 There's a growing movement towards 'upcycling' old furniture, transforming forgotten pieces into stylish, unique items for the home.**
It's fantastic for sustainability and allows for incredible creativity, giving pre-loved items a brand new lease of life.
- 5 A study has found that listening to the sound of rainfall can significantly improve concentration and reduce stress levels.**
Next time you need to focus or relax, try putting on some gentle rain sounds – it seems our brains find it wonderfully soothing.
- 6 The art of 'letter writing' is experiencing a quiet revival, with many finding joy in sending and receiving handwritten notes.**
It's a thoughtful way to communicate, and there's something truly special about holding a physical letter in a world of instant messages.
- 7 Experts are suggesting that even a short daily walk in nature can drastically improve mental well-being and creative thinking.**
Just ten minutes amongst trees or in a park can clear your head and spark new ideas, a simple pleasure with big benefits.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'tidying' what on a hotel breakfast buffet, even if it's not our job?

ANSWER: THE CROISSANT PILE, MAKING SURE THEY LOOK PERFECT!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a specific 'ritual' when making a cup of tea or coffee that we absolutely must follow. What is it?

ANSWER: STIRRING CLOCKWISE EXACTLY SEVEN TIMES!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a particular 'smell' can instantly transport you back to a specific memory or a moment in time?

Whether it's the scent of freshly cut grass reminding you of childhood summers, or a particular perfume that brings back a special person, what's a smell that holds a strong memory for you, and what's the story behind it?

- We all have those little 'shortcuts' we take in life, don't we? Things we've discovered that make a task quicker, easier, or just a bit more efficient.

Maybe it's a clever way to peel vegetables, a route you know that avoids traffic, or a secret trick for untangling knots. What's your favourite everyday 'life hack' or shortcut that you swear by?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **History.** During World War II, carrots were promoted by the British government as a way to help people see in the dark, to encourage their consumption.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The first public telephone box in the UK was painted bright pink before being changed to the iconic red by popular demand.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£4.75 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£4.75 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's smallest independently owned country is Sealand, located on an old WWII sea fort off the coast of Suffolk.
- A group of owls is called a parliament.
- Butterflies taste with their feet.
- The longest recorded flight of a chicken is 13 seconds.
- Scotland has a national animal, and it's the unicorn.
- The 'king' in a deck of cards is the only one without a moustache.
- It is illegal to sing in public after 9 PM in Hawaii.
- Human tooth enamel is the hardest substance in the human body.

On this day

Day 167 of the year, 198 days left in 2026. Today Birthday of Leonard P. Howell (Rastafari); Bloomsday (Dublin, Ireland); Christian feast days: Aurelianus of Arles; Christian feast days: Aureus of Mainz (and his sister Justina). Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1946 — Tom Harrell, American trumpet player and composer
- 1968 — James Patrick Stuart, American actor
- 1941 — Lamont Dozier, American songwriter and producer (died 2022)
- 1943 — Joan Van Ark, American actress
- 1993 — Gnash, American singer, songwriter, rapper, DJ and record producer
- 1947 — Tom Malone, American trombonist, composer, and producer
- 1974 — Joseph May, British-born Canadian-American actor
- 1957 — Ian Buchanan, Scottish-American actor

THE DAY TODAY

- 1955 — In a futile effort to topple Argentine President Juan Perón, rogue aircraft pilots of the Argentine Navy drop several bombs upon an unarmed crowd demonstrating in favor of Perón in Buenos Aires, killing 364 and injuring at least 800. At the same time on the ground, some soldie...
- 1958 — Imre Nagy, Pál Maléter and other leaders of the 1956 Hungarian Uprising are executed.
- 1972 — The largest single-site hydroelectric power project in Canada is inaugurated at Churchill Falls Generating Station.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2000 — The Secretary-General of the UN reports that Israel has complied with United Nations Security Council Resolution 425, 22 years after its issuance, and completely withdrew from Lebanon. The Resolution does not encompass the Shebaa farms, which is claimed by Israel, Syria and Le...
- 1995 — The Astronomy Picture of the Day website is launched.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2002 — Padre Pio is canonized by the Roman Catholic Church.

2013 — A multi-day cloudburst, centered on the North Indian state of Uttarakhand, causes devastating floods and landslides, becoming the country's worst natural disaster since the 2004 tsunami.

- 2010 — Bhutan becomes the first country to institute a total ban on tobacco.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 168 of the year, 197 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Albert Chmielowski; Christian feast day: Botolph (England and Scandinavia); Christian feast day: Gondulphus of Berry; Christian feast day: Hervé. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1947 — Timothy Wright, American gospel singer, pastor (died 2009)
- 1967 — Eric Stefani, American keyboard player and composer
- 2000 — Odessa A'zion, American actress
- 1940 — Chuck Rainey, American bassist
- 1975 — Joshua Leonard, American actor, director, and screenwriter
- 1947 — Gregg Rolie, American rock singer-songwriter and keyboard player
- 1942 — Roger Steffens, American actor and producer
- 1970 — Michael Showalter, American actor, director, producer, and screenwriter

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1972 — Watergate scandal: Five White House operatives are arrested for burgling the offices of the Democratic National Committee during an attempt by members of the administration of President Richard M. Nixon to illegally wiretap the political opposition as part of a broader campaig...
- 1953 — Cold War: East Germany Workers Uprising: In East Germany, the Soviet Union orders a division of troops into East Berlin to quell a rebellion.
- 1960 — The Nez Perce tribe is awarded \$4 million for 7 million acres (28,000 km2) of land undervalued at four cents/acre in the 1863 treaty.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1972 — Watergate scandal: Five White House operatives are arrested for burgling the offices of the Democratic National Committee during an attempt by members of the administration of President Richard M. Nixon to illegally wiretap the political opposition as part of a broader campaig...
- 2015 — Nine people are killed in a mass shooting at Emanuel African Methodist Episcopal Church in Charleston, South Carolina.

Coming to cinemas

JUNE 2026	
FRI 19	Pixar's Toy Story 5
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life

JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JUNE 2026		JULY 2026	
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
18–21 JUN	U.S. Open (Golf)	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon	18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
		23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
		AUGUST 2026	
		W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
		22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)